CONTRACTOR SUPPORT OF U.S. OPERATIONS IN THE USCENTCOM AREA OF RESPONSIBILITY

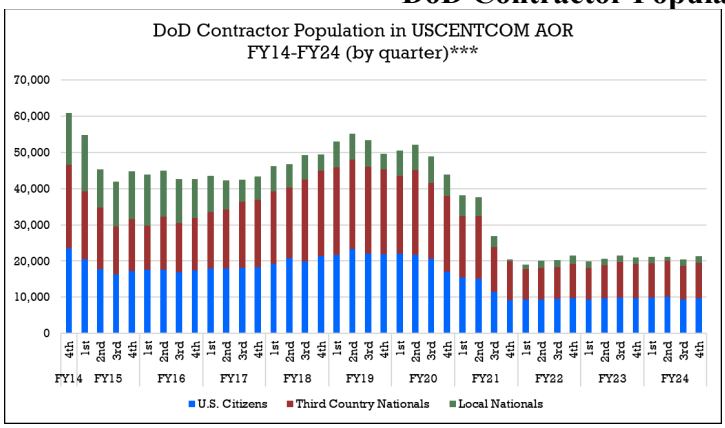
BACKGROUND: This report provides Department of Defense (DoD) contractor personnel numbers for 4th quarter Fiscal Year 2024 (FY24) and the current status of efforts underway to improve management of contractors accompanying United States (U.S.) Forces. It includes data on DoD contractor personnel deployed in Iraq and Syria, Operation Inherent Resolve (OIR), and the U.S. Central Command (USCENTCOM) area of responsibility (AOR). During FY25, the Department will conduct a review and develop an updated plan for future reports.

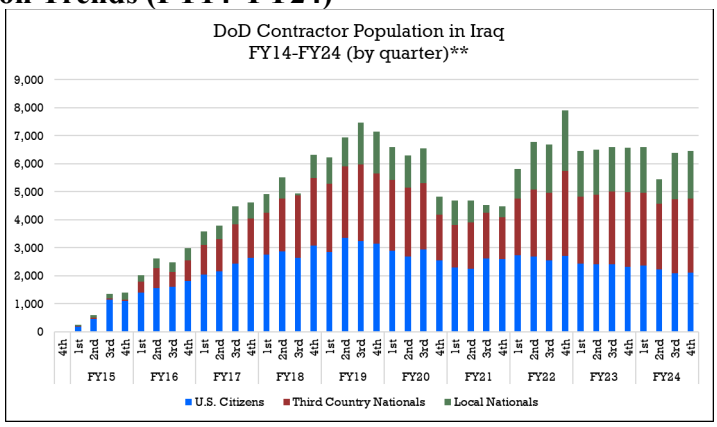
KEY POINTS: During 4th quarter FY24, USCENTCOM reported approximately 21,341 contractor personnel supporting DoD in the USCENTCOM AOR, an increase of approximately 957 from the previous quarter.

DoD Contractor Personnel in the USCENTCOM AOR

	Total Contractors	U.S. Citizens	Third Country Nationals (TCN)	Local Nationals
Iraq and Syria	6,450	2,116	2,640	1,694
Other USCENTCOM Locations	14,891	7,631	7,163	97
USCENTCOM AOR	21,341	9,747	9,803	1,791

DoD Contractor Population Trends (FY14–FY24)*





* To maintain a 10-year quarterly view of contractor populations, the date range has been changed to reflect FY14-FY24 data.

** Information on the contractor population in Syria was incorporated starting 2nd quarter FY18.

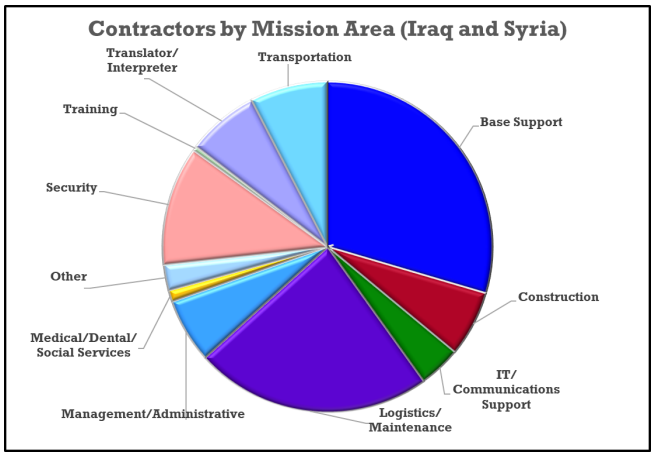
*** Information on the contractor population in Israel is included in the USCENTCOM AOR totals starting in 4th quarter FY21.

Prepared by: ODASD(Log) October 2024

OIR (Iraq and Syria) Summary

- The distribution of contractors in Iraq and Syria by mission category are:

Base Support	1,904	29.6%
Construction	416	6.5%
IT/Communications Support	266	4.2%
Logistics/Maintenance	1,499	23.2%
Management/Administrative	406	6.3%
Medical/Dental/Social Services	73	1.1%
Other	163	2.5%
Security	751	11.6%
Training	28	0.4%
Translator/Interpreter	452	7.0%
Transportation	492	7.6%
Total:	6,450	



  - Contractor Posture: Approximately 6,450 DoD contractors directly supported DoD-funded contracts in Iraq and Syria. This is an increase of 0.98% from 3rd quarter FY24.

- **USCENTCOM Operational Contract Support (OCS) Branch (CCJ43):**
  - **Vendor Threat Mitigation (VTM).** During this quarter, CCJ43 reviewed 53 vendors; 29 vendors (54%) were rated as an "acceptable" force protection risk and 23 (43%) were identified as "unacceptable without mitigation. Vendors rated as "unacceptable without mitigation" require completion of a risk mitigation plan or installation access denial letter. Additionally, all Section 841 individuals and entities that were previously identified by the USCENTCOM Deputy Commander as having provided support to enemies received an annual review. CCJ43 retained 49 entities' Section 841 designation and recommended removal for 2 entities based on new information.
  - Also, this quarter CCJ43 focused on the coordination of critical contract support associated with the contract closure of the Gaza Foreign Humanitarian Assistance Joint Logistics Over the Shore mission. This coordination ensured critical contract support efforts were paid and closed out in a timely manner. Additionally, CCJ43 completed and returned to the Joint Staff, the FY24 military assessments on commercial capabilities.
  - **Combined Joint Task Force - Operation INHERENT RESOLVE (CJTF-OIR) Operational Contract Support Integration Cell (OCSIC)**:
    - During this quarter, CJTF-OIR heavily relied on the Defense Logistics Agency (DLA) for end-of-year acquisitions due to DLA's later, September procurement submission deadline. The later timeline allows for greater flexibility to obligate end-of-year funds as well as satisfy last-minute supply purchase requirements. The OCSIC processed approximately 32 submissions made directly to DLA by various Task Forces within the CJOA.
    - Due to the volume of DLA submissions and limited OCSIC visibility, CJTF-OIR implemented new processes for DLA requests, including parallel scheduling of a Joint Requirements Review Board.

IMPROVEMENTS TO MANAGEMENT AND OVERSIGHT OF DOD CONTRACTORS

- **Office of the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics (ODASD(Log)):**
  - **OCS Governance and Oversight**. On August 26, 2024, the Deputy Assistant Secretary of Defense for Logistics and the Vice Director for Logistics, (JS J4) co-chaired the 4th quarter FY24 OCS Functional Capabilities Integration Board (FCIB) meeting. The meeting included an update from U.S. Africa Command on its OCS program, OCS integration in Campaign Planning, and OCS in support of current operations. The Marine Corps provided an update on their future operating concept, "Expeditionary Advanced Base Operations and Force Design 2030," and how the OCS capability is evolving to support those operations. Other OCS FCIB presentations included updates on Global Market Research Initiative and Synchronized Predeployment Operational Tracker-Enterprise Suite resourcing. The next meeting will be held on November 20, 2024.
  - **OCS Joint Capability Improvement Working Group (CIWG) Update**. On July 18, 2024, the CIWG convened to discuss initiatives underway across the entire OCS community to improve OCS capability and integrate commercial support to operations into policies and processes, as well as planning and execution. Offices of Primary Responsibility continue to implement their respective actions as documented in the OCS Action Plan. The next meeting will be held on October 24, 2024.
  - **Defense Standards for Security Services:**
    - All DoD contracts for private security services require compliance with American National Standard Institute (ANSI) PSC.1-2012 (R2017), "Quality Management Standard for Private Security Company Operations" or International Organization for Standardization (ISO) 18788-2015 "Management Systems for Private Security Operations." All private security companies contracted by DoD at any tier are currently compliant with one or both of the existing standards and have achieved independent third-party certification.
    - The DoD continues to review timelines for companies to transition to the revised standard, ANSI/ASIS PSC.1-2022 "Management System for Private Security Company Operations—Requirements with Guidance."
    - A total of 114 private security companies from 35 different countries have achieved independent third-party certification to one or both standards.
- **Defense Logistics Agency, J73, Acquisition Operations:** During this quarter the J73 supported the U.S. European Command Planning Workshop in Stuttgart, Germany, which addressed contractor management challenges, and reviewed North Atlantic Treaty Organization concept plans, leading to the development of an Annex W. These efforts, assisted by a DLA reservist, culminated in the successful development of a DLA Annex W in support of U.S. Northern Command (USNORTHCOM) and U.S. Strategic Command Homeland Defense Integrated Plans.
- **JS J45, Operational Contract Support Division, (OCSD):**
  - **Assessments and Reporting.** Combatant Commands, Services, and Agencies completed their FY24 military assessments on commercial capabilities. J45 OCSD will use responses to inform strategic assessments and guidance.

- **Individual Training.**
  - **Joint OCS Planning and Execution Course (JOPEC).** During the 4th quarter FY24, J45 OCSD trained 77 students, through a combination of remote-learning and in-person JOPEC offerings hosted by the USNORTHCOM and the Naval Supply Systems Command.
  - **Joint Enabling Capabilities Command (JECC), Joint Planning Support Element (JPSE), Joint Enhanced Training (JET).** J45 OCSD facilitated JET events for 66 JPSE planners and mentors at the JECC from August 9-11, 2024, focusing on developing decision-support matrices and tools to help commanders make timely, informed decisions, including those related to commercial capabilities in military operations. Prior to the JET, on July 25, 2024, J45 OCSD provided a two-hour training session on commercial capabilities and OCS considerations at the Joint Task Force level to 20 JPSE planners.
  - **Joint Knowledge Online (JKO).** J45 OCSD continues to develop a four-phase suite of training to replace the current Joint OCS Essentials for Commanders and Staff suite. The first two phases are available to students on the JKO platform:
    - OCS I, *Leveraging Commercial Capabilities Across the Competition Continuum*. A total of 2,943 students have completed OCS I to date.
    - OCS II, *OCS Fundamentals*. A total of 1,050 students have completed OCS II to date.
  - **Joint Logistics Course (JLC), Army Sustainment University (ASU).** J45 OCSD delivered OCS instruction at three sessions of the JLC, on July 22, August 15, and September 18, 2024, to a total of 116 attendees.
  - **Joint Logistics Planning Course (JLPC) Pilot, ASU.** J45 OCSD participated in a proof-of-concept event July 30-31, 2024, supporting the development of the JLPC pilot course. The JLPC will equip graduates with the requisite strategic and operational knowledge and skills to effectively plan logistics support in interagency, inter-organizational, and multinational operations in a dynamic environment. J45 OCSD's role in the planning event was to inject and refine commercial capability considerations and OCS concepts, policies, and procedures in the proposed course curriculum. Subsequently, on September 17-18, 2024, J45 OCSD taught the OCS block of instruction at a JLPC pilot, with 21 students in attendance.
- **OCS in Exercises**. J45 OCSD participated in the out-brief of the Integrating Allied & Partner Capacity Wargame II, hosted by the Institute for Defense Analyses. Among lessons learned, the game participants strongly acknowledged a deficiency in OCS and commercial capability considerations in terms of reliance, risks, opportunities, and resilience.
- **OCS Lessons Learned.** J45 OCSD completed the FY24 Joint OCS Lessons Learned data pull. Four organizations submitted input to the Joint Lessons Learned Information System, resulting in the collection of eight best practices and three observations. J45 OCSD, as the Enterprise Lesson Manager for OCS, briefed the results to the OCS FCIB Council of Colonels at the 4th quarter FY24 meeting.